

Alex Chen

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven Senior Software Engineer with 12 years of professional experience and 8 years specializing in distributed systems, cloud architecture, and high-scale microservices. Proven track record of architecting platforms processing 10M+ daily requests with 99.99% uptime, reducing cloud spend by 25% (\$400K annually), and optimizing ETL pipelines handling 50TB/day. Hands-on full stack expertise across Go, Kubernetes, AWS, React, PostgreSQL, and modern observability tooling. Experienced leader of cross-functional engineering teams of 5–6, with a strong focus on mentorship, on-time delivery, and measurable business impact.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer — TechCorp (2021 – Present) | San Francisco, CA

- Architected microservices platform handling 10M+ daily requests with 99.99% uptime, built on Go, Kubernetes, Istio, Kafka, gRPC, PostgreSQL, and Redis on AWS EKS.
- Reduced cloud spend by 25% (\$400K annually) through rightsizing, autoscaling, and architectural optimization of AWS infrastructure.
- Led a 6-engineer platform team, owning end-to-end delivery, code quality, and on-call operations for 500+ microservices.
- Implemented observability stack using Prometheus, Grafana, Jaeger, and ELK, achieving P99 latency under 50ms and MTTR under 5 minutes.
- Mentored senior and junior engineers on distributed systems design, SRE best practices, and full stack development workflows.

Senior Engineer — DataFlow Systems (2017 – 2021) | San Francisco, CA

- Designed and built distributed ETL pipelines processing 50TB daily across 200+ nodes using Apache Spark, Kafka, Airflow, AWS S3, and Redshift.
- Reduced query latency by 60% through schema optimization, partitioning, and indexing strategies across the data warehouse layer.
- Cut infrastructure costs by \$300K annually by migrating workloads to cost-efficient AWS services and implementing spot-instance strategies.
- Led a 5-engineer data platform team, delivering 12 production projects on time and within scope.
- Mentored 3 junior developers through structured growth plans, resulting in mid-level promotions within 18 months.

CORE SKILLS & TECHNOLOGIES

Go, Kubernetes, Istio, Kafka, gRPC, REST APIs, Microservices Architecture, Distributed Systems, AWS EKS, AWS S3, Redshift, PostgreSQL, Redis, Apache Spark, Airflow, ETL Pipeline Design, Prometheus, Grafana, Jaeger, ELK Stack, CI/CD, Infrastructure as Code, React, TypeScript, Node.js, System Design, Mentorship & Team Leadership

KEY PROJECTS

High-Throughput Microservices Platform (Go, Kubernetes, Istio, Kafka, gRPC, PostgreSQL, Redis, AWS EKS)

Designed and operated a cloud-native microservices platform at TechCorp serving 10M+ daily requests with 99.99% uptime, leveraging Go, Kubernetes, Istio, and gRPC on AWS EKS.

Distributed ETL Data Platform (Apache Spark, Kafka, Airflow, AWS S3, Redshift)

Built a petabyte-scale ETL pipeline at DataFlow Systems processing 50TB daily across 200+ nodes, using Apache Spark, Kafka, Airflow, AWS S3, and Redshift.

Enterprise Observability Suite (Prometheus, Grafana, Jaeger, ELK Stack, Kubernetes)

Implemented a unified observability platform monitoring 500+ microservices with Prometheus, Grafana, Jaeger, and the ELK stack.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science — University of California, Berkeley (2013) | GPA: 3.8/4.0